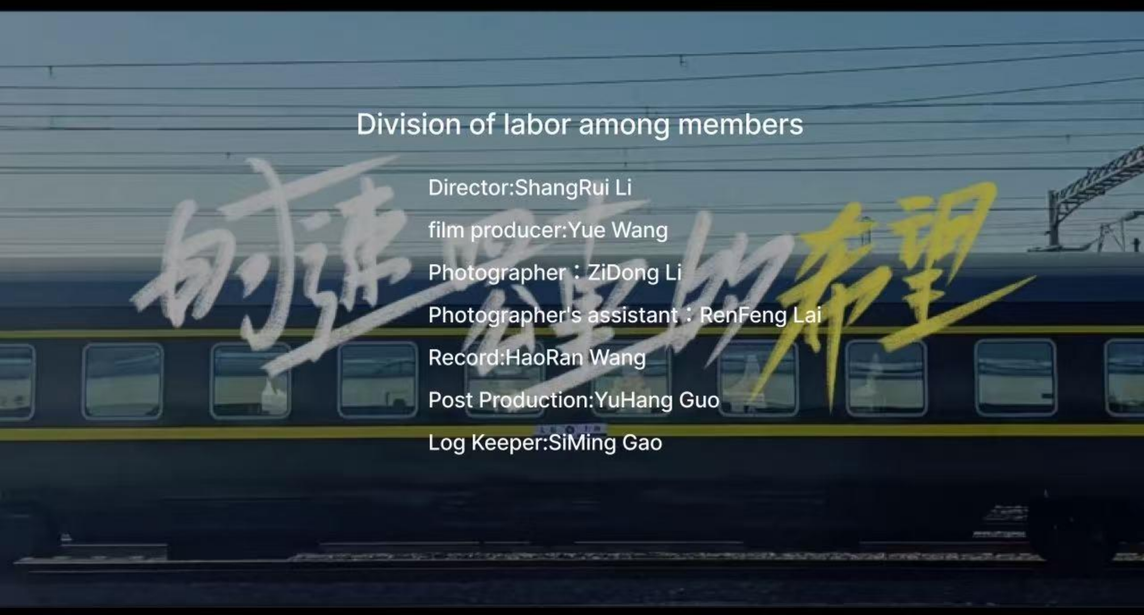
The hope of the 40 kilometers per hour

Group Project

https://youtu.be/SO4_UKbtssY?si=a0YxZn06JyqxlQtz



Division of labor among members

Director:ShangRui Li

film producer:Yue Wang

Photographer：ZiDong Li

Photographer's assistant：RenFeng Lai

Record:HaoRan Wang

Post Production:YuHang Guo

Log Keeper:SiMing Gao

Inspiration

In a time when daily life grows faster and transportation becomes increasingly optimized for speed, China's 5633 slow train stands as a striking exception. Moving through remote mountains at a pace unchanged for decades, it carries values that contemporary society often overlooks.

My inspiration comes not from viewing this train as "behind," but from recognizing the alternative vision of progress it represents: development measured not only by speed, but by fairness, connection, and the right to be seen. The continued operation of this train is not a compromise in the age of high-speed rail, but a deliberate commitment to the needs of remote communities.

On the 5633 train, the long travel time draws people closer. It functions not only as transportation but as a social lifeline—an example of "slow publicness" that remains essential within a rapidly modernizing landscape.

So when the dominant narrative celebrates acceleration, who protects those whom speed has ignored, yet still deserve to be served and respected?

Project Background

Following China's "14th Five-Year Plan" (2021–2025), the 5633 public welfare slow train has actively responded to national calls by improving service quality and strengthening social development and livelihood support. In early 2023, the train underwent a service upgrade, creating its unique service brand "Yi Ethnic Affection".

As 2025 marks the final year of the 14th Five-Year Plan, our team learned about the last green train operating on the Chengdu–Kunming Railway—the 5633 public welfare slow train. The warmth embodied in its mission of "helping mountain communities keep pace with the times and ensuring no one is left behind" inspired us to take this train as the theme of our project.

Based on the 5633 service, we plan to create a documentary exploring how a "slow train" can still bring people onto a "fast track." The film will follow Yi women as they move through the carriages, carrying luggage filled with hope and cultural heritage, symbolizing their communities' transition into a faster era—running forward together with the times.